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However, it speeds up the attainment of equilibrium by providing a new pathway having a lower activation energy.

For example, in the synthesis of NH_3 by the Haber's process iron is used as a catalyst. Similarly, in the contact process of manufacturing SO_3, platinum or V_2O_5 is used as a catalyst.

8.8.5 Effect of inert gas

When an inert gas (i.e, a gas which does not react with any other species involved in equilibrium) is added to an equilibrium system at constant volume, the total number of moles of gases present in the container increases, that is, the total pressure of gases increases. the partial pressure of the reactants and the products are unchanged. Hence at constant volume, addition of inert gas has no effect on equilibrium.

Table 8.3: Effect of concentration, pressure, temperature, catalyst and Inert gas on equilibrium

Condition	Stress	Direction in which equilibrium shifts
Concentration	Addition of reactants (increase in reactant concentration)	Forward reaction
	Removal of products (decrease in product concentration)	
	Addition of products (increase in product concentration)	Reverse reaction
	Removal of reactants (decrease in reactant concentration)	
Pressure	Increase of pressure (Decrease in volume)	Reaction that favours fewer moles of the gaseous molecules
	Decrease of pressure (Increase in volume)	Reaction that favours more moles of the gaseous molecules
Temperature(Alters equilibrium constants)	Increase (High T)	Towards endothermic reaction
	decrease (Low T)	Towards exothermic reaction
Catalyst (Speeds up the attainment of equilibrium)	Addition of catalyst	No effect
Inert gas	Addition of inert gas at constant volume	No effect